Ocean through the deep passages and straits of the Indonesian Archipelago.

This is the only place in the world where warm, equatorial waters flow from one ocean to another. This warm tropical water influences the character of the Leeuwin Current.

The Leeuwin Current

Begins around mid-way along the Western Australian coast and flows down the coast and around the bottom of Western Australia. The Leeuwin Current then flows Eastward across the Great Australian Bight and reaches as far as the west coast of Tasmania as the Zeehan Current.

The East Australian Current

This current moves southward from near Fraser Island in Queensland to the eastern coast of Tasmania.

The East Australian Current is usually stronger in summer, when it reaches further south, often bringing with it northern tropical species such as tuna and even large sea turtles following the current into Bass Strait.

The East Australian Current is a Western Boundary current and is renowned for shedding eddies off the Queensland and New South Wales coasts.

The Antarctic Circumpolar Current

The Antarctic Circumpolar Current moves perpetually eastward chasing and joining itself and at 21,000 km in length, it comprises the world's longest ocean current, carrying an estimated 165 million to 182 million cubic metres of water every second (a unit also called a "Sverdrup") from west to east, more than 100 times the flow of all the rivers on Earth. transporting 130 million cubic m of water per second (4.6x109 cu ft/s) 100 times the flow of all the world's rivers. It extends from the sea surface to the bottom of the ocean, and encircles Antarctica.

75. **Salinity of Australian Waters**

- Across the north coast of Australia the ocean areas have lower salinity due to fresh water input from high rainfall compared to the ocean areas surrounding most of Australia.
- The salinity of the ocean regions south of the tropics and above the Southern Ocean is higher due to high evaporation and low